

DESIGN YOUR DREAM ECO-LODGE

ASSIGNMENT BACKGROUND

South Africa is one of the third most biologically diverse countries, with an extensive network of conservation parks and protected areas that provide an ideal setting for ecotourism (South African Yearbook, 2022). According to South Africa's Ecotourism Framework, ecotourism promotes responsible travel that supports conservation, minimises environmental impacts, and benefits local communities (DFFE, 2023).

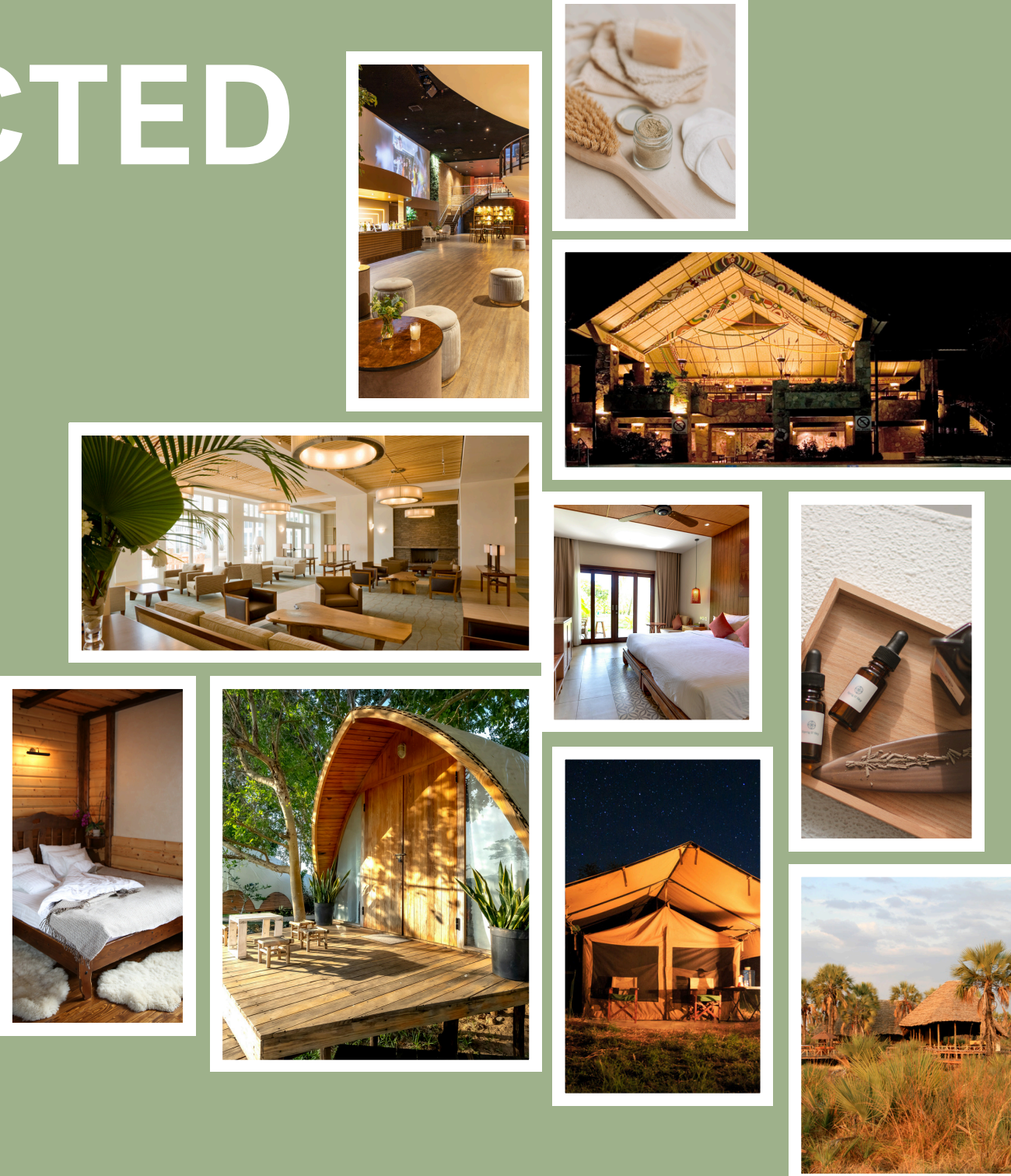
As future hospitality professionals, your group has been appointed as the management team responsible for designing a new eco-lodge in South Africa.



WHAT IS EXPECTED OF YOU?

Your task is to develop a new eco-lodge in a suitable location in South Africa and create a **digital identity (website and social media platforms)** for the **eco-lodge** using digital design platforms (e.g., **CANVA**).

HOT TIP: Imagine that your final product has been developed and has been launched for potential markets.



REQUIREMENTS

- Divide into groups of **10 students**.
- Divide the responsibilities among the members of the group.
- Submit the assignment via a Link in an email to **carlin.barnes@nwu.ac.za** with your group number as the subject line.
- To receive a group number, you have to fill in all your group members' names on the designated **form in class**.
- The form will be available in every class until **14 August 2026**.

Due: 5 October 2026

ECO-LODGE WEBSITE SHOULD INCLUDE:

- **Business welcome page** (Name, logo, slogan and location)
- **Description** (Why should tourists choose your Lodge?)
- **Staff information page** (All group members: Photo, student details, role in the Lodge with an accompanying description)
- **Accommodation** (photos of rooms, grounds, restaurant and menu, prices unless you opt for an enquiries tab, etc.)
- **Activities** (at lodge / surrounding area) / **Experiences** (wellness/spa/game drives/weddings) / **Conference options**
- **Sustainability principles** (Rules to save water/electricity/manage waste, etc.)
- Link that directs you to other **online platforms** (must correlate with website)
- **Promotional or grand opening video (BE CREATIVE)**



RUBRIC

CRITERIA	MARKS
Business Profile & Branding (logo & slogan)	/15
Website presence (good use of images/popups/videos, easy to navigate, has a search bar, has links to other platforms, has reviews, payment methods, management/partnerships information, etc.)	/20
Team Roles clearly indicated and described	/15
Menu for restaurant, clear indication of rooms available, prices, activities, experiences and conference options stipulated	/10
Promotion or grand opening video (On website and related social platforms)	/15
Engaging content (use of videos, reels or an integrated chatbot)	/10
Language, grammar, spelling	/5
Visual Creativity & Design (idea consistency throughout website and social platform posts)	/10

TERMS & CONDITIONS:

STEP 1: FIND A GROUP

- It is your responsibility to find a group. I will give you some time after class to make new besties (or at least assignment allies). No group = no project = no mercy = no marks awarded.

STEP 2: GROUP DRAMA? NOT MY PROBLEM!

- Suppose there's tension in your group - welcome to adulthood! Where you learn how to **COMMUNICATE**, **COMPROMISE**, and **SURVIVE** daily!

STEP 3: THE GHOST MEMBER?

- **If someone in your group mysteriously disappears or doesn't lift a finger, you have two options:**
 1. Let me know with proof (screenshots, emails, etc. attached to the email)
 2. Or go full "Survivor" and vote them off the island (a.k.a. remove them from the group).

